



MONTHLY UPDATE

Central African Republic: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-06 · 10 systems and instruments tracked, 19 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

A month-long mobile outage at a northern town took out voice, data and mobile money together, and [left some officials unpaid for the previous month because salary transfers run over mobile services](#). It is the clearest record the base holds of what single-operator dependency costs.

The government declared the September 2025 memorandum on the incumbent operator's privatisation [in its operational phase on 16 July, with US\\$150m announced for network modernisation, a data centre and connectivity](#). Definitive agreements, a steering committee and a schedule are unfinalised, and the figure appears in no appropriation.

The statistics institute [put enumerator teams into the field on 20 July for a harmonised household living-conditions survey](#) – about 7,000 households, entirely by tablet, over six months.

Infrastructure

Subscribers at a northern town reported [no calls, no internet and no mobile money for close to a month, with no restoration date](#). The failure is attributed to off-grid relay sites, equipment theft and repair crews travelling hundreds of kilometres, on a network with one operator and no redundancy; the base held nothing on this locality before.

On 16 July the minister met the counterparty's operations vice-president, moving the [incumbent operator's privatisation into an operational phase](#). US\$150m is announced across network modernisation, a data centre and connectivity; the deal structure is undisclosed, and definitive takeover agreements, a joint steering committee and a deployment schedule are all still to be established. It is the fourth attempted rescue of this operator, the prior one agreed in November 2020, needing EUR 20m and never funded.

Digital public infrastructure

Modernisation works opened at the central treasury accounting agency on 27 July for an [application deployed for the treasury single account, tied to regional banking rules and integrated with the regional settlement rails](#). Its stated object is centralising state balances and eliminating parallel and opaque accounts. No cost, financier, vendor,

timetable or number of accounts closed is stated, and the architecture is explicitly regional rather than national — the public finances plan of June 2025 named six systems and a data centre and no treasury single account application.

Mobile money is the salary rail outside the banked areas, and it failed with the network. The most recent enrolment figure held remains [1,702 civil servants in regions without banking services](#), recorded as a project achievement in May 2025; at the affected town, [prepaid bundles expired unused while the network was down](#).

On 30 July a memorandum was signed at Bangui covering [digital finance and land banking, presented as mobilising investment for infrastructure while modernising land administration](#). No commitment figure, disbursement schedule or governance arrangement is stated, and it couples a payments ambition and a land-registry ambition under one offshore private counterparty. Against it, the cadastre itself has no delivery record: the 2026 medium-term framework carries [FCFA 625,000 for updating the mining cadastre and FCFA 650,000 for a petroleum database](#), FCFA 1,275,000 between them for the year.

The statistics institute [deployed enumerator teams nationwide on 20 July, opening six months of collection across about 7,000 households in three two-month waves, entirely by tablet](#), with a public commitment to statistical secrecy and aggregates only. The field period ends around January 2027; no results date is stated and no prior harmonised survey is held.

Governance and regulation

The regional central bank and the payments body [launched an interoperable QR-code standard at Douala on 29 July under an April 2026 regulation](#), binding across the six member states, routed and settled through the regional switch and secured to card-industry standards. The country's share of regional payment volume was 0.43% in 2024 — the smallest but one, against the largest member state's 65.10% — and no country-specific adoption step is on file. The regional report holds no value figure or account count for the country, so what the standard reaches here cannot be sized.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

The month's only technology-sector item is the [privatisation memorandum's move to an operational phase](#), carried here because the counterparty is a United States firm. The announced US\$150m is the counterparty's own figure and appears in no appropriation.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

The [digital finance and land-banking memorandum signed at Bangui on 30 July](#) is the only Gulf-state item the base holds for the country at any date, and its counterparty is otherwise undocumented. It carries no commitment figure, disbursement schedule, timetable or governance arrangement, and registers as intent rather than finance.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-06
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.com/reports/CAF/CAF-monthly-2026-07.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.com/reports/CAF/CAF-monthly-2026-07-2026-08-06.pdf
DERIVED FROM	Data Landscapers source base, commit <code>ea6e045ec0be</code>
VERIFY	Hash this file and look it up in https://corpus.data-landscapers.com/manifest.csv
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